

Travel health Action Sheet

Peru · Lagos, Nigeria → Lima, Peru · 90 days · Leisure
May 11, 2026

SECTION 1: CRITICAL ACTIONS BEFORE DEPARTURE

- Book a pre travel health consultation with your primary care physician or a travel medicine clinic immediately; aim for at least 6 to 8 weeks before 21 May 2026 departure
- Initiate rabies pre exposure prophylaxis (3 doses over 21 to 28 days) as a priority given rural environment and outdoor activities in a rabies endemic country
- Receive or confirm hepatitis A vaccination; single dose provides immediate protection if time is limited
- Confirm hepatitis B immunity or begin accelerated vaccination series given anticipated new sexual partners

SECTION 2: TRIP SNAPSHOT

Alone, 90 days, Leisure, overall risk HIGH

SECTION 3: VACCINES

No qualifying vaccines listed in dossier.

SECTION 4: WHAT TO PACK AND DAILY ROUTINE

- Malaria prophylaxis: Atovaquone proguanil (Malarone) or doxycycline; discuss with clinician. Malaria (predominantly *Plasmodium vivax*, with some *Plasmodium falciparum*) is present in rural and jungle regions of Peru. Lima city itself is not a malaria risk area. However, the traveller has indicated a rural stay environment and outdoor hiking activities over 90 days, which raises the probability of travel to or through malaria risk zones. Atovaquone proguanil is well tolerated, has no neuropsychiatric side effects, and is suitable for this traveller given no contraindications. Doxycycline is an effective alternative and also provides some protection against leptospirosis and rickettsial infections relevant to rural outdoor activities, but requires strict sun protection (photosensitising). Mefloquine is not preferred for a first time traveller without prior tolerance assessment. The clinician should confirm the specific regions within Peru to be visited to determine whether prophylaxis is required and for what duration of the 90 day stay.
- Pre travel review and vaccination records: Book a pre travel health consultation with your primary care physician or a travel medicine clinic as soon as possible, ideally at least 6 to 8 weeks before your 21 May 2026 departure. Bring all existing vaccination records. Priority vaccines to initiate or confirm before departure include: hepatitis A, hepatitis B (accelerated schedule if needed), typhoid, yellow fever, rabies pre exposure prophylaxis, and influenza. Confirm routine vaccines (MMR, Tdap, polio, varicella) are documented and up to date. Given the 90 day duration and rural environment, this pre travel consultation is clinically important and should not be deferred.
- Food and water hygiene: In rural Peru, tap water is not safe to drink. Drink only bottled water with intact seals, or water that has been boiled or treated with iodine or chlorine tablets. Avoid ice in drinks unless you are certain it was made from purified water. Eat only thoroughly cooked food served hot. Avoid raw or undercooked meat, shellfish, and fish. Be cautious with salads, raw vegetables, and fruit that cannot be peeled. Avoid food from street vendors unless it is freshly cooked and served hot. Wash hands thoroughly

with soap and water before eating and after using the toilet; carry alcohol based hand sanitiser (at least 60 percent alcohol) for situations where handwashing is not possible. These precautions apply throughout the trip, including in hotels.

- Vector bite prevention: Peru has active dengue fever transmission in many regions, and malaria risk in rural and jungle areas. Both are mosquito borne. Apply DEET repellent (30 to 50 percent) to all exposed skin every 4 to 6 hours. Wear permethrin treated long clothing during outdoor activities. Use a bed net if sleeping in non air conditioned accommodation. Dengue mosquitoes (*Aedes aegypti*) bite during the day, so protection is required at all hours, not only at night. If you develop fever, headache, muscle pain, or rash during or after the trip, seek medical attention promptly and inform the clinician of your travel to Peru.
- Sun, heat, and environmental precautions: Apply SPF50 or higher broad spectrum sunscreen to all exposed skin, reapplying every 2 hours and after swimming or sweating. Wear a wide brimmed hat and UV protective sunglasses during outdoor activities. Avoid prolonged sun exposure between 10am and 3pm. Stay well hydrated with safe water, particularly during hiking. If you travel to high altitude regions of Peru (above 2,500 metres, such as Cusco or the Andes), allow at least 2 to 3 days for acclimatisation before strenuous activity. Symptoms of acute mountain sickness include headache, nausea, dizziness, and fatigue; descend immediately if symptoms are severe. Discuss acetazolamide (a medication to prevent altitude sickness) with your clinician before departure if highland travel is planned. Lima city has notable air pollution; those with respiratory conditions should take precautions.
- Injury and road safety: Road traffic injuries are a leading cause of death and serious injury for travellers in Peru. Always wear a seatbelt in vehicles. Avoid travelling by road at night in rural areas where possible. Use reputable, licensed transport providers. During hiking, use established trails, wear appropriate footwear, carry sufficient water and a basic first aid kit, and inform someone of your planned route and expected return time. As a solo traveller, this is especially important. Avoid swimming in unfamiliar rivers, lakes, or coastal areas without local knowledge of currents and hazards. Be aware of leptospirosis risk from freshwater exposure in rural areas (see below).
- Sexual health and blood exposure: You have indicated you anticipate new sexual partners during this trip. Use condoms consistently and correctly for every sexual encounter to reduce the risk of HIV, gonorrhoea, chlamydia, syphilis, and other sexually transmitted infections (STIs). Confirm hepatitis B vaccination before departure. Discuss PrEP (pre exposure prophylaxis, a daily medication that significantly reduces HIV acquisition risk) with your clinician before departure if you anticipate higher risk sexual activity; PrEP requires a prescription and baseline HIV testing. Know how to access PEP (post exposure prophylaxis for HIV, which must be started within 72 hours of potential exposure) in Lima; identify a clinic or hospital in advance. Avoid tattooing, piercing, or cosmetic procedures in Peru unless you can verify sterile professional facilities. Avoid sharing needles or any equipment that may contact blood.
- Jet lag, sleep, and mental wellbeing: Lagos (West Africa Time, UTC+1) to Lima (Peru Time, UTC 5) represents a 6 hour time difference. Expect disruption to sleep patterns for several days after arrival. Gradually adjust sleep and meal times toward Lima time in the days before departure. Expose yourself to natural daylight on arrival to help reset your circadian rhythm. Avoid heavy alcohol use during the adjustment period. A 90 day solo trip to an unfamiliar country can be mentally demanding; plan regular contact with family or friends at home. Be aware of signs of culture shock, isolation, or low mood, particularly in the first few weeks. Identify a mental health support resource in Lima before departure if needed.

SECTION 5: RED FLAGS AND EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Seek emergency medical care immediately for: fever above 38 degrees Celsius within 3 months of return (exclude malaria urgently), severe headache with neck stiffness or rash, difficulty breathing, chest pain, signs of severe dehydration, or any animal bite or scratch that occurred during the trip.

CLINICAL FACILITIES

Clinica Internacional, Jr. Washington 1471, Lima 15001, Peru

Clinica Anglo Americana, Alfredo Salazar 350, San Isidro, Lima 15073, Peru

LOCAL EMERGENCY NUMBER

105 (Police), 116 (Ambulance/SAMU), 115 (Fire)

INSURANCE

Insurance: Yes (confirm medical evacuation and repatriation cover)

Full clinical dossier attached. Share with your travel medicine clinician at your pre-travel appointment.